

Seawall height in Jupiter

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

JUPITER • PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Jupiter sets no minimum seawall height. It caps new bulkheads at the property's FEMA base flood elevation, and a bulkhead more than 3 ft above mean high water must be fully faced with riprap or mangroves.

The detail

MINIMUM	None set in Sec. 27-2624 (Shoreline stabilization)
MAXIMUM	Top of new bulkhead must be at or below the property's required base flood elevation on current FEMA maps - Sec. 27-2624(8)
EXEMPTIONS TO MAX	Properties east of the Coastal Construction Control Line; Riverwalk properties where ADA slope cannot be met - Sec. 27-2624(8)a-b
RIPRAP TRIGGER	Top more than 3 ft above mean high water line requires 100% riprap/mangrove facing - Sec. 27-2624(1)c, (2)d
LOCATION	Replacement within 18 in. waterward of existing permitted bulkhead (one-time waterward move since 6/16/2015) - Sec. 27-2624(1)-(2)
RIPRAP PLACEMENT	Riprap must cover the bottom half of the bulkhead, sloped no steeper than 2:1, and may not reach more than 8 ft waterward of the mean high water line. No filter cloth is needed - Sec. 27-2624(5)b
MANGROVE FOLLOW-UP	Within two years of final inspection, mangroves must be established on at least 10% of the riprap-faced shoreline; if not, 20% of the shoreline must then be planted - Sec. 27-2624(5)c-d
OLD UNPERMITTED WALLS	When replacing an unpermitted bulkhead, a dated survey or historical aerial proving it existed before 20 Dec 2005 excuses the riprap, as long as the new top stays within 3 ft of mean high water. Wood or other degradable walls must be removed - Sec. 27-2624(2)f, (2)h

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.